

that can be rigged to control a garage door using the existing locking or motor-driving mechanism. It also notifies the owner when the door opens.

Another interesting automated-door lock system is August Smart Lock that works with the deadlock already on the door.

Connection 4: Monitoring your home virtually

One much talked about solution here is Eve home monitoring system by Elgato. It offers a huge set of sensors that let you measure weather, water, energy, smoke and other elements, and provide statistics of how these have been varying. It can also be connected to systems like HomeKit.

Merging home automation with wearable technology. With devices like Apple Watch and smartpendants arriving on the scene, you do not need to dig through your pockets for a smartphone or take your laptop out

Smarthome solutions by tech giants

Apple's HAP Kit. Apple with its HomeKit framework has made a strategic move to enter the smarthome market. The large installed base of its smartphones and tablets with the powerful voice assistant, Siri, provides a platform for a basic, easy-to-use plug-and-play-type smarthome solution.

Google Nest Lab Solution. Nest thermostats automatically create a heating or cooling schedule based on the daily routines of residents. Initially, residents are required to set the target room temperature by turning Nest thermostat wheel several times a day. Once these settings are stored, the thermostat is capable of building a temperature schedule and profile. Nest thermostats are Internet-connected and get updated through the Internet. Nest acquired streaming video camera maker Dropcam and integrated its products with Dropcam's surveillance capabilities.

Samsung SmartThings. Samsung is another vendor that has created a set of SmartThings automation devices, which can be used in smarthomes. Samsung mobile phones can control all these devices. In addition to this, Samsung supports IFTTT, a Web based service that allows users to create a chain of conditional statements. Its expanded form is 'If This Then That,' conveying what it actually stands for.

—S.A. Srinivasa Moorthy, director, D4X Technologies Pvt Ltd



to connect or monitor your home. Two-way communication between your wearable device and your home allows you to not only monitor your home but also control it.

Firms like Creston have started to bring out apps that run on your

watch that let you turn on lights, adjust the air-conditioner, stream music or open the garage door using your watch. Using Symbol Intensive Master Programming Language (SIMPL), other developers can support their own devices through Creston app.

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